

T H E

Thyroid Protocol

SUPPORT. BALANCE. ACTIVATE.

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GUTGURU PROTOCOL

Table of Contents

01 How the Thyroid Works

02 Dietary Support for Thyroid Function

03 Thyroid Support vs Suppressors

04 The Thyroid Support Formula

05 Common Thyroid Mistakes

06 Myth Busters

CHAPTER 01

Understanding Thyroid Function

The thyroid produces hormones that regulate metabolism, energy, weight, mood, and body temperature — making diet a powerful lever.



T4 to T3 Conversion

The thyroid produces mostly T4 (inactive). It must be converted to T3 (active hormone) in the liver and gut. Selenium and zinc catalyse this conversion.



Iodine: The Raw Material

Iodine is the essential building block of thyroid hormones. Deficiency is the most common cause of hypothyroidism globally — still prevalent in certain Indian regions.



Gut-Thyroid Axis

20% of T4-to-T3 conversion happens in the gut. A disrupted gut microbiome impairs thyroid hormone activation — often missed in standard thyroid management.



Autoimmune Thyroid (Hashimoto's)

Hashimoto's — the most common hypothyroid cause — is an autoimmune condition. An anti-inflammatory, potentially gluten-reduced diet meaningfully reduces antibody load.

CHAPTER 02

Diet Impact on *Thyroid* Health

IODINE
OPTIMISATION**52% TSH improvement**

Foundation

SELENIUM-
RICH DIET**45% T3 activation**

Conversion

LOW-
GOITROGEN
DIET**38% antibody drop**

Autoimmune

ANTI-
INFLAMMATORY**30% less inflammation**

Hashimoto's

Selenium is the most evidence-backed dietary intervention for thyroid function — it directly activates the enzyme (deiodinase) that converts T4 to active T3. Brazil nuts, fish, eggs, and sunflower seeds are the best sources.



KEY TAKEAWAY

Take thyroid medication on an empty stomach — 30–60 minutes before food, coffee, or calcium supplements. Co-ingestion reduces absorption by up to 40%.

CHAPTER 03

Support vs Suppress

The interaction between food and thyroid function is more nuanced than "avoid goitrogens" — cooking method and quantity change everything.

SUPPORT

Thyroid-Supporting Foods

These provide iodine, selenium, zinc, and anti-inflammatory compounds the thyroid needs to function.

Iodised salt Fish (rohu, pomfret) Eggs
Brazil nuts (1–2/day) Sunflower seeds
Pumpkin seeds Dairy (milk, curd) Walnuts
Turmeric

LIMIT

Thyroid Suppressors (Raw)

Goitrogenic compounds in raw cruciferous vegetables interfere with iodine uptake — cooking neutralizes this.

Large raw soy intake also affects conversion.

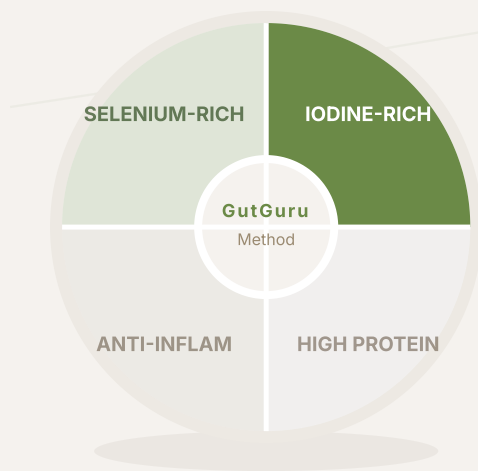
Raw cabbage daily Raw broccoli daily
Raw cauliflower daily Excess raw soy
Millet (large daily amounts)
Fluoridated water excess

Cooking cruciferous vegetables (broccoli, cabbage, cauliflower) at 100°C for 10+ minutes neutralizes 90%+ of goitrogenic compounds. Cooked cruciferous veg daily is safe.

CHAPTER 04

The Thyroid Support Formula

THE GUTGURU THYROID METHOD

**Iodine-Rich Foods**

Fish, iodised salt, dairy, eggs

+

**Selenium-Rich Foods**

Brazil nuts (1–2/day), sunflower seeds, eggs

+

**Anti-Inflammatory**

Turmeric, ginger, walnuts, omega-3 fish

+

**Quality Protein**

Eggs, paneer, dal, fish, Greek yoghurt

EXAMPLE MEAL

Egg + oats + curd + sunflower seeds + turmeric milk**Cooked cruciferous = safe · selenium daily · iodised salt always**

THE 3 NON-NEGOTIABLE THYROID RULES

CHAPTER 05

Common *Thyroid* Mistakes

**Eating large amounts of raw cruciferous vegetables daily**

Raw broccoli, cauliflower, and cabbage contain goitrogens that block iodine uptake. Cooking neutralizes this — the issue is raw and daily, not cooked and occasional.

**Taking thyroid medication with tea, coffee, or calcium**

Levothyroxine absorption is reduced by up to 40% when taken with food, coffee, or calcium supplements. Always take on an empty stomach.

**Consuming large amounts of raw soy products daily**

Soy isoflavones interfere with T4 to T3 conversion. Moderate amounts of cooked soy (tofu, edamame) are fine. Large daily raw soy intake is the issue.

**Assuming medication means diet is irrelevant**

Diet determines selenium availability for T3 conversion, gut microbiome health for hormone activation, and inflammation levels that affect medication effectiveness.

**Ignoring selenium in favour of only iodine**

Without selenium, iodine alone cannot activate thyroid hormone. Selenium deficiency is as common as iodine deficiency in India and equally impactful.

CHAPTER 06

Quick Myth Busters

MYTH

You must completely avoid all cruciferous vegetables with a thyroid condition.

TRUTH

Cooking cruciferous vegetables at 100°C neutralizes over 90% of goitrogenic activity.

Cooked broccoli, cauliflower, and cabbage are safe and nutritious daily foods.

MYTH

Thyroid disease means you will gain weight regardless of diet.

TRUTH

With optimised medication and a thyroid-supportive diet, weight management is entirely achievable. Uncontrolled weight gain is a sign of under-treated thyroid — not an inevitable outcome.

MYTH

You need special "thyroid superfoods" to heal your thyroid.

TRUTH

No single food cures thyroid dysfunction. Adequate iodine (via iodised salt and fish), selenium (via eggs and sunflower seeds), and an anti-inflammatory diet are the evidence-based approach.

TAKE THIS HOME

Your 3 Quick Wins

Three specific actions you can start this week — no equipment, no cost, measurable results.

1

Switch to Iodised Salt Today — Permanently

Check your salt packet. If it does not say "iodised," **replace it with iodised salt today**. This is the cheapest and most evidence-backed thyroid intervention available — and most Indian households have already switched, but many have not.

STARTING TODAY

2

Take Your Thyroid Medication 30–60 Minutes Before Food

Set a phone alarm 45 minutes before breakfast to take your levothyroxine. Food, coffee, and calcium supplements reduce its absorption by up to 40%. This single habit change can improve medication effectiveness more than dose adjustments.

EVERY MORNING

3

Eat 1–2 Brazil Nuts Every Day

1–2 Brazil nuts daily is all the selenium you need to support T4-to-T3 conversion — the critical activation step most thyroid diets ignore. Brazil nuts are the most bioavailable selenium source available and more effective than supplements.

ONCE DAILY — AS A SNACK

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READY TO PERSONALIZE?

Book a 1-on-1 Consultation

Get a clinical nutrition plan tailored to your thyroid health, body,
and lifestyle.

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